

Mauro Martinelli

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Academic appointments

05/2025 - present

Postdoctoral Researcher, Bocconi University

DONDENA Centre for Research in Social Dynamics and Public Policy

ERC project FRAILIFE: Child Disability and Family Life

- Study the spillover effects of child disability on family members' health-protective behaviors, wellbeing and life-course trajectories.
- Combine population-level data and online textual data to study less visible dimensions of families' having a child with a disability
- Contribute to interdisciplinary research, grant writing and outreach to academic and non-academic audiences

03/2023 - 04/2025

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Copenhagen

Department of Sociology

DFF project HABITS: Using online search data to measure social desirability bias

- Developed computational methods for comparative longitudinal analysis of online search data as behavioral indicators.
- Collected, harmonized and analyzed large-scale digital trace data using APIs and browser automation, integrating them with survey-based measures.
- Produced reproducible workflows, manuscripts, grant proposals and conference presentations for interdisciplinary audiences.
- **Visiting researcher** at Sciences Po Médialab, Paris, with Achim Edelmann, April 2024.

06/2022 - 02/2023

Researcher, University of Trento

Department of Sociology

H2020 project PERISCOPE: Pan-European response to future pandemics and epidemics

- Designed and managed a multi-country survey on pandemic-related attitudes, behaviors, health and mental health.
- Analyzed cross-national data for European Commission deliverables on the consequences of COVID-19 pandemic.
- Coordinated a research group to ensure to ensure comparable analysis and reporting.

Additional Professional experience

01/2022 - 06/2023

Consultant, Punto 3 srl, Ferrara, Italy

- Developed a client's network-analysis project, including sampling, design and fielding of data collection.
- Conducted data analysis, visualization and report writing.
- Delivered project results, including presentation of findings to company stakeholders.

Education

- May 2022 **Ph.D. Sociology and Social Research**, University of Trento.
Dissertation title: *Understanding Vaccine Hesitancy. Three Essays on the Role of Risk, Trust and Cognitive Characteristics in Vaccine Acceptance.*
- Sept. 2015 **M.A. Sociology**, 110/110 with honours, University of Trento.
- Sept. 2011 **B.A. Communication Studies**, 110/110 with honours, University of Padova.

Further selected training

- July 2026 Advanced methods for Quantitative Text Analysis, Essex Summer School.
- Feb. 2022 Advanced Panel Data Analysis, ECPR Winter School.
- Mar. 2021 Causal Machine Learning in R, GESIS Spring School.
- Dec. 2020 Advanced Methods for Policy Evaluation, FBK Winter School, Trento.
- Feb. 2020 Machine Learning for Social Science, ECPR Winter School, Bamberg.

Teaching experience

- Apr. 2026 **Lecturer**, PhD program in Social and Political Science, Bocconi University
- Oct. 2024 **Teaching Assistant**, Master's degree in Sociology, University of Copenhagen.
- 2019–2021 **Teaching Assistant**, Quantitative Methods for Social Science. Undergraduate level, University of Trento, School of International Studies.
- 2019–2021 **Teaching Assistant**, Survey and Sampling Design. Undergraduate level, University of Trento, School of International Studies.

Academic service

- Reviewer for:** *Scientific Reports; European Sociological Review; Social Science & Medicine; SSM – Population Health; BMC Public Health; PLOS ONE; Information, Communication & Society.*
- from 09/2025 **Scientific committee** Alpine Population Conference, Bocconi University
- 09/2024 - 04/2025 **Chair**, Knowledge, Organization and Politics research group, University of Copenhagen.
- March 2020 **Research Assistant**, EU Commission, JRC/IPR/2019/Chafea/2015/CP/02, “Data collection activity on Vaccine Hesitancy”.

Selected conference and presentations

- May 2026 ECSR Conference, Trinity College, Dublin. “Cervical cancer screening in mothers of children with disabilities. Evidence from the UK.”
- May 2026 EPC Conference, University of Bologna. “Uptake of Cervical Screening among Mothers of Children with Disabilities: Evidence from Finland.”
- Feb 2025 MZES Lab, Mannheim University. “Novel Data Sources, New Methods and Computational Approaches for Understanding Discrimination and Bias.” (invited)
- Apr. 2024 Médialab Science Po. “Using internet search data for comparative longitudinal research.” (invited)
- Sept. 2024 ECSR Conference, UPF, Barcelona. “Investigating social desirability bias in survey measures of discriminatory attitudes using digital trace data.”
- July 2024 IC2S2 Conference, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia. “Using internet search data for comparative longitudinal research.”
- Feb. 2024 SISEC Conference, University of Cagliari, Cagliari. “Regional and cross-national prevalence of racist attitudes in Europe. Evidence from online search behavior.”
- Sept. 2022 ECSR Conference, University of Amsterdam. “COVID-19 vaccine acceptance: A comparative longitudinal analysis of the association between risk perception, confidence, and the acceptance of a COVID-19 vaccine.”
- Sept. 2021 ESA Conference, Barcelona Online. “How perceived risk and trust in vaccination frame individuals’ vaccine acceptance.”

Publications

- Martinelli, M., and Veltri, G. A. (2024). COVID-19 vaccine acceptance: A comparative longitudinal analysis of the association between risk perception, confidence, and the acceptance of a COVID-19 vaccine. *Risk Analysis*, 44, 802–816. <https://doi.org/10.1111/risa.14200>.
- Martinelli, M., and Veltri, G. A. (2022). Shared understandings of vaccine hesitancy: How perceived risk and trust in vaccination frame individuals' vaccine acceptance. *PLOS ONE*, 17(10), e0276519. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0276519>.
- Martinelli, M., and Veltri, G. A. (2021). Do cognitive styles affect vaccine hesitancy? A dual-process cognitive framework for vaccine hesitancy and the role of risk perceptions. *Social Science & Medicine*, 289, 114403. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.114403>.
- Galesi, D., and Martinelli, M. (2017). Quando la morte rompe i tabù. L'approccio professionale degli operatori hospice ai malati terminali. *Salute e Società*, 3, 119–132. <https://doi.org/10.3280/SES2017-003010>.

Working papers

- Martinelli, M., and Merhout, F. Using Internet Search Data to Produce Long-Running Comparable Time Series: A Hybrid Method Combining Google Trends and Google Ads Data. R&R at *Sociological Methods & Research*.
- Martinelli, M., and Balbo, N. Cervical cancer screening in mothers of children with disabilities: Evidence from the UK.
- Martinelli, M., and Lievore, I. Disentangling the relationship between excess mortality and perceived risk: Longitudinal insights from a rolling cross-section approach.